‘Fight to Win’, which means you enter a battlefield with the determination and firm belief that you will emerge victorious.

Gentlemen, I have always endeavoured to be different by not following the beaten track. Being unpredictable, unconventional and attempting to do the impossible, and achieving ‘surprise’ were essential parts of my strategy in all facets of my life as a soldier. This has been fundamental to my success story.

You, the future officers of the armed forces, will be the custodians of the faith that your countrymen repose in you. You will be called upon to pitch in, in all aspects of nation-building. Gentlemen, you shall do well to recall the pride of place assigned to a soldier in our society. A warrior is looked upon as the last bastion of hope. The armed forces have successfully achieved all their objectives through three pillars of soldiering. These are: secularism, an apolitical outlook and professionalism. These are the values you shall uphold. This is the ethos that must guide every action of yours. Your ‘dharma’ is to defend our country and its people. It is, therefore, imperative that you arm yourselves with knowledge and train yourselves to fulfil your responsibilities as a warrior.

A revolution in military affairs is sweeping the Indian Army. Fresh thinking, prompted by the swiftly changing world environment, is revolutionizing the way military affairs are conducted and managed. Technological growth and scientific developments have radically transformed the military thought process. Information warfare, network centred warfare, integrated command and control systems (C4ISR) – this is the operational paradigm that modern armies have to train and equip themselves in, so as to retain the winning edge. It will be your responsibility to spearhead this revolution through a judicious mix of knowledge and actual local ground realities.

And now I would like to share my thoughts with the gentlemen cadets from friendly foreign countries. India has a time-honoured tradition of helping our friends. We have training teams in many countries, participation in UN peacekeeping operations and the proud privilege of training cadets of friendly foreign countries. It pleases me that thirty-six foreign cadets will pass out today. Dear cadets, please remember that you came here as friends and you will